

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

Case Nos. 2019-5561, 2019-6283 & 2019-6315

AMENDED ORDER OF SUMMARY SUSPENSION

TO: MELODIE KAY COLLINS, LPC, LMFT

The State Board of Licensed Professional Counselor Examiners ("Board"), having reviewed all available information as to the matters referenced below, HEREBY FINDS AS FOLLOWS:

1. Melodie Kay Collins ("Respondent") was licensed to practice as a licensed professional counselor ("LPC") in the State of Colorado on February 7, 2012, and was issued license number LPC.6389. Respondent has been so licensed at all times relevant herein and is now so licensed.

2. The Board has jurisdiction over the Respondent and the subject matter herein pursuant to the Colorado Mental Health Practice Act, § 12-245-101, C.R.S., *et seq.*

3. On or around July 23, 2019, the Board received a complaint against Respondent (Case No. 2019-5561) alleging that Respondent was engaged in a sexual relationship with a client.

4. On or around September 5, 2019, the Board received a second complaint against Respondent (Case No. 2019-6283) alleging that Respondent was engaged in a sexual relationship with a client.

5. On or around September 7, 2019, the Board received a third complaint against Respondent (Case No. 2019-6315) alleging that Respondent was engaged in a sexual relationship with a client.

6. Upon receiving each complaint, the Board sent a letter to Respondent requiring her to submit a response to the allegations within thirty (30) days.

7. Respondent submitted a response to the allegations in the complaint on December 2, 2019.

8. The Board referred the complaints to the Department of Regulatory Agencies' Office of Investigations to conduct a full investigation into the allegations against Respondent.

9. Upon full investigation of the documents and information presented in regard to Case Nos. 2019-5561, 2019-6283, and 2019-6315, the Board finds as follows:

- a. Respondent engaged in a dual relationship with a client, in violation of § 12-245-224(1)(i), C.R.S.; and
- b. Respondent engaged in a sexual relationship with a client, in violation of § 12-245-224(1)(r), C.R.S.

10. Upon full investigation of the documents and information presented, the Board finds objective and reasonable grounds to believe and finds that Respondent is not safe to practice professional counseling with reasonable skill and safety to patients, and the public health, safety, and welfare imperatively requires emergency action. As a result, Respondent's license to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado must be summarily suspended.

11. The Board hereby summarily suspends Respondent's license to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado pursuant to §§ 24-4-104(4) and 24-4-105(12), C.R.S.

12. Respondent cannot engage in the practice of professional counseling in the State of Colorado or hold herself out as able to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado while her license is suspended.

13. Any violation of this Order constitutes a violation of a lawful Board Order and may be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to § 12-245-224, C.R.S. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with this Order.

14. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to the Board or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.

15. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Board.

THEREFORE, pursuant to the above, IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that the license of Melodie Kay Collins to practice professional counseling in the State of Colorado is suspended.

EFFECTIVE this 21st day of April, 2020.

STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL
COUNSELOR EXAMINERS



WENDY ANDERSON
Interim Program Director